

and then shared (with various access rights) among all processes running on the local system, or loaded and mapped in all processes started in a user session when the user logs on the system.

The HKEY LOCAL MACHINE (local machine-specific configuration data) and HKEY CURRENT USER (user-specific configuration data) nodes are similar in structure; user applications typically look up their settings by first looking in “HKEY CURRENT USER\Software\Vendor’s name\Application’s name\VersionSetting name,” and if that doesn’t work, look in the same location under the HKEY LOCAL MACHINE key. The opposite may be true for administrator-enforced policy settings, where HKLM may take precedence over HKCU. The Windows Logo Program includes precise standards for where different sorts of user data can be stored, as well as following the principle of least privilege so that administrator-level access is not necessary to utilise an application. 